

Who Said **What?**

Six scenes, two people each, one backstory each. Complete the sentences with the verb the context asks for, GET, MAKE, LET, ALLOW or HAVE. Then work through the vocabulary, the glossary, and the conversation questions at the end.

PART 1

The Six Scenes

Complete each sentence with the verb the context asks for.

01 THE REPORT

David, the manager

David has managed this team for six years. Last month he let it slide, hoping the mistake wouldn't happen again. He was wrong.

Tom, the employee

Tom is used to talking his way out of tight deadlines. It's worked before, more than once.

1. Last month, Tom _____ David to accept a rushed draft without checking it properly.
2. This time, David _____ him redo the whole report before 5pm, whether he likes it or not.
3. David usually _____ small mistakes slide, but not this time.
4. Company policy doesn't _____ employees to skip a final review.

02 THE PERFORMANCE REVIEW

Ken, the manager

Ken has sat across this desk from Laura every quarter for two years. He's watched her get praised, then promoted, and now, for the first time, questioned.

Laura, the employee

Laura has always found a way to smooth things over before a review even starts. Not this time.

1. For two years, Laura _____ her manager to overlook small mistakes by working extra hours.
2. This performance review _____ her feel anxious, even though she's done nothing wrong this time.
3. Ken doesn't usually _____ a review shake someone this much.
4. As official company policy, the company _____ every employee to request a second opinion on their review.

03 THE NAPKIN PITCH

Mark

Mark asked Julia to meet him for what he promised would be a quick coffee. That was thirty minutes ago.

Julia

Julia came in skeptical. She's heard pitches like this before, and most of them go nowhere.

1. Mark _____ Julia to meet him by promising it would only take ten minutes.
2. Now he's _____ her to reconsider the whole plan.
3. Julia finally _____ him explain the numbers on a napkin, arms still crossed.
4. If he can't _____ her to agree today, he'll try again next week.

04 THE SCOOTER

Sam, the son

Sam has been asking for this for weeks. Tonight, he finally has an answer.

Mike, the dad

Mike almost said no. It's getting dark, and part of him wants to wait until the weekend.

1. Sam _____ his dad to agree by promising to always wear the helmet.
2. Mike finally _____ him ride the scooter around the block, just this once.
3. Sam already knows exactly how to _____ his dad to say yes next time too.
4. Mike doesn't usually _____ him go out after dark, but tonight is different.

05 THE Q3 REPORT

Diane, the manager

Every Friday, Diane hands this task to whoever's turn it is on the rotation. This week, it's Kevin's.

Kevin, the employee

Kevin has done this report before. It's routine, not a big deal.

1. Every Friday, Diane _____ someone on the team prepare this update.
2. Since it's his turn on the rotation, she _____ Kevin walk her through the numbers before the meeting.
3. Kevin didn't need convincing, Diane just _____ him do what's already part of his role.
4. It took no convincing at all, Diane simply _____ him bring the report to the meeting room.

06 THE FRONT DESK

James, security

James has worked this front desk for three years. The rule is the same for everyone, no matter how many times they've visited before.

Chris, the visitor

Chris registered online this morning, expecting today to be quick and simple.

1. The company _____ Chris to register online before he even arrived.
2. James doesn't _____ anyone skip the sign-in sheet.
3. Once his badge scans clean, security _____ him through.
4. The sign on the wall doesn't _____ any exceptions.

PART 2

Vocabulary Practice

Match each expression, then fill in the gaps below.

MATCH THE EXPRESSION TO ITS MEANING

- let it slide
smooth things over
overlook
skeptical
pitch
reconsider
rotation
routine
walk (someone) through
sign-in sheet

FILL IN THE GAP

- David decided to _____ instead of punishing Tom right away.
Word bank: overlook / let it slide / reconsider
- Tom is good at trying to _____ a tight deadline.
Word bank: walk through / smooth over / talk his way out of
- The report was full of errors because it was a _____.
Word bank: rushed draft / sign-in sheet / routine
- Ken reviews Laura's performance every _____.
Word bank: exception / quarter / rotation
- She tried to _____ after the tense meeting.
Word bank: overlook the problem / reconsider the plan / smooth things over
- He tends to _____ small mistakes if the work is otherwise solid.
Word bank: overlook / pitch / walk through
- Julia was _____ about the plan at first.
Word bank: routine / skeptical / promising

8. Mark gave his _____ over coffee, hoping to convince her.

Word bank: rotation / exception / pitch

9. After hearing the numbers, she agreed to _____ her decision.

Word bank: reconsider / overlook / let it slide

10. Sam rode his scooter _____ before dinner.

Word bank: on a rotation / off routine / around the block

11. He kept _____ to wear the helmet every time.

Word bank: overlooking / promising / reconsidering

12. Diane assigns the report based on the weekly _____ .

Word bank: rotation / pitch / exception

13. For Kevin, preparing the report is just _____ now.

Word bank: skeptical / rushed / routine

14. Kevin will _____ the numbers before the meeting.

Word bank: let her slide / walk her through / overlook

15. Every visitor must use the _____ at the front desk.

Word bank: sign-in sheet / rotation schedule / rushed draft

16. The rule applies to everyone, no _____ .

Word bank: mistakes / rotations / exceptions

APPENDIX A

Glossary

All the expressions from the six scenes, grouped by scene.

THE REPORT

let it slide — deixar passar, não punir

talk your way out of — se safar conversando, convencer alguém a deixar passar

rushed draft — rascunho feito às pressas

THE PERFORMANCE REVIEW

quarter — trimestre, período de 3 meses no mundo corporativo

smooth things over — contornar a situação, resolver de forma tranquila

overlook — não reparar, deixar passar

let something shake you — deixar algo te abalar

THE NAPKIN PITCH

skeptical — desconfiado(a), com pé atrás

pitch — proposta, argumento de venda

reconsider — repensar, reconsiderar

THE SCOOTER

around the block — ao redor do quarteirão

promising — prometendo

THE Q3 REPORT

rotation — rodízio, escala entre a equipe

routine — rotina, nada fora do comum

walk (someone) through — explicar passo a passo

THE FRONT DESK

sign-in sheet — folha de registro de entrada

badge scans clean — o crachá é lido sem problema no scanner

exceptions — exceções

APPENDIX B

Conversation Questions

For the speaking wrap-up. Discuss, no right answer needed.

Does letting things slide make a team stronger over time, or does it just build up bigger problems?

LET IT SLIDE

Should a good manager overlook small mistakes, or is that just a bad habit dressed up as kindness?

OVERLOOK

What makes a pitch convincing: the idea itself, or the person presenting it?

PITCH

Why do some routines feel comforting, while others start to feel like a trap?

ROUTINE

What's more effective for getting someone to reconsider a decision: showing them data, or appealing to how they feel?

GET SOMEONE TO + RECONSIDER

Is it better to walk someone through a task step by step, or let them figure it out on their own?

WALK (SOMEONE) THROUGH

Do you think it's ever okay to make an exception to a rule? Give an example.

MAKE AN EXCEPTION

Can you really get someone to change their mind, or do people only ever change it on their own?

GET SOMEONE TO DO

What's the real difference between a manager who lets things happen and one who makes things happen?

LET / MAKE

Is smoothing things over always the right move, or does it sometimes just avoid a problem that needs to be solved?

SMOOTH THINGS OVER

Would most people rather have more freedom or more guidance at work? Why do you think that is?

WOULD RATHER HAVE

Should companies allow more flexibility, or does too much freedom end up hurting productivity?

ALLOW / DOESN'T ALLOW

APPENDIX C

Answer Key

For the teacher, or to check your own work.

SCENE ANSWERS

01 · The Report: 1. got, 2. makes, 3. lets, 4. allow

02 · The Performance Review: 1. got, 2. makes, 3. let, 4. allows

03 · The Napkin Pitch: 1. got, 2. getting, 3. let, 4. get

04 · The Scooter: 1. got, 2. lets, 3. get, 4. let

05 · The Q3 Report: 1. has, 2. has, 3. had, 4. had

06 · The Front Desk: 1. got, 2. let, 3. allows, 4. allow

VOCABULARY MATCHING

let it slide → deixar passar, não punir

smooth things over → contornar a situação, resolver de forma tranquila

overlook → não reparar, deixar passar

skeptical → desconfiado(a), com pé atrás

pitch → proposta, argumento de venda

reconsider → repensar, reconsiderar

rotation → rodízio, escala entre a equipe

routine → rotina, nada fora do comum

walk (someone) through → explicar passo a passo

sign-in sheet → folha de registro de entrada

FILL IN THE GAP

1. let it slide

2. talk his way out of

3. rushed draft

4. quarter

5. smooth things over

6. overlook

7. skeptical

8. pitch

9. reconsider

10. around the block

11. promising

12. rotation

13. routine

14. walk her through

15. sign-in sheet

16. exceptions